Lesson plan · for the teacher

Design an agent for a school job

AI agents · Level 4 · Lesson 1

Time
40 min

Materials
Five job cards (answering parents about homework, attendance summaries, the weekly news, library help, duty reminders); Ten tool cards: calculator, timetable, weather, library, attendance, glossary, reminder, convert, route, send message; Large paper or the board, and markers

Learning goals

- Start a design from a job and what a mistake would cost.
- Give an agent only the tools its job needs.
- Split the work into roles, with a person approving actions.

Activity: Design sprint

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask: which school job would you hand to an agent, and which would you never hand over? Collect answers on the board in two columns.
2. Teach (8 min): Show the four design steps: the job and who it serves, what a mistake would cost, the fewest tools (a permissions table), and the roles (planner, checker, runner, a person who says yes).
3. Design (15 min): Each group takes a job card and the ten tool cards, and writes a one-page design: the job, the cost of a mistake, the tools as a permissions table, where a person must approve, and how you will know it works.
4. Swap and check (8 min): Groups swap pages and play the checker. They mark one tool the job doesn't need, or one action with no approval, and give the page back.
5. Wrap-up (4 min): Each group says what it cut. Agree on the best design for one job, then give the exit ticket.

Prepare five job cards and a set of the ten tool cards for each group (paper is enough). No phones are needed.

Discussion

- Which job at our school is too risky to hand to an agent at all?
- Why is a checker made of simple rules often safer than a clever one?
- Who should be named as responsible for an office agent?

Exit ticket

- Write one school job, the tools it needs, and one tool you would leave out.

Try it at school tomorrow
Run a design sprint: groups take one school job and write a one-page design (the job and who it serves, what a mistake would cost, the fewest tools, who approves, and how you will know it works). Then groups swap pages and hunt for an extra tool or a missing approval.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **Who should approve the weekly news before the agent sends it to parents?**

◯ The agent itself, if it's confident ◯ A named person at school ◯ Nobody: it's only news

2 **An agent will answer parents' questions about homework. Which tools does that job need? Choose all that apply.**

☐ The library (which books to read) ☐ Pupils' attendance records ☐ A reminder for the head teacher

☐ The timetable (which lesson is when) ☐ Send message to any parent

3 **Complete the homework agent's permissions: the timetable runs freely, a message must wait for a person, and a tool missing from the table is off.**

```
PERMS = {
    "timetable": "_____",
    "library": "allowed",
    "send_message": "_____",
}
tool = "attendance"
level = PERMS.get(tool, "_____")
print(level)
```

Word bank: `yes` `run` `ask` `allowed` `off`

4 **Put the design steps in order.**

☐ Choose the fewest tools the job needs

☐ Name the job and the people it serves

☐ Decide the roles and who approves actions

☐ Set a success measure and a responsible person

☐ Say what a mistake would cost

5 **Match each role to what it does.**

Planner (the model)	• • • •	Runs the tool and adds the result
Checker (rules in code)	• • • •	Proposes each tool call
Runner (the app)	• • • •	Says yes or no to actions
A person	• • • •	Reviews the call before it runs

✎ **Pick one job at your school you might hand to an agent. Which tools would you give it, which would you leave out, and who would approve its actions?**

Check your answers

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1 **A named person at school**

A message to every parent is an action. A named person reads it and says yes, and the school knows who is responsible.

2 **The timetable (which lesson is when); The library (which books to read)**

Answering homework questions needs the timetable and the library.

3

```
PERMS = {
    "timetable": "allowed",
    "library": "allowed",
    "send_message": "ask",
}
tool = "attendance"
level = PERMS.get(tool, "off")
print(level)
```

"allowed" lets the timetable run, "ask" makes a message wait for a person's yes, and get(tool, "off") gives "off" for any tool not in the table, so attendance prints off.

4 **Top to bottom: 3, 1, 4, 5, 2**

The job and its stakes come first, because they decide how many tools and how many checks the agent gets.

5 **Planner (the model) — Proposes each tool call**
Checker (rules in code) — Reviews the call before it runs
Runner (the app) — Runs the tool and adds the result
A person — Says yes or no to actions

Only the planner is a model. The checker and the runner are code that doesn't guess, and the final yes for any action belongs to a person.